

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

In ALT this month:

Talking to animals like Dr Doolittle? Digit AutoTech, ever popular DGT and of course some sci-fi and some data on why air travel isn't getting faster...



Lunar Litter

When it comes to keeping our planet clean, we don't really have a good track record. So of course, we're the same when we went to the moon as well. NASA has actually made a list of all 809 objects we've 'left behind' on the moon.

<http://dgit.in/lunarlitter>

WHAT'S NEW

Super female crayfish

A mutant species of crayfish that are all-female are taking over the world. Literally. The crayfish do not need males to mate and reproduce. As such, they are multiplying rapidly and invading ecosystems around the world. This particular crayfish are descended from one single female crayfish with a mutation which allowed it to reproduce without males. All of its offspring are also female only. These self-cloning crayfish can actually be found for sale in North America, and not for eating purposes but to keep as pets. People have been advised against doing so for obvious reasons.

The mutated crayfish was born to a male and female slough crayfish, a species native to Florida. The mutated crayfish had an additional set of chromosomes, which basically allowed it to



reproduce without having to mate. The mutation has also officially been declared a separate species from its parents, the marbled crayfish.

These crayfish can now be found in the wild in Japan, Madagascar, Europe and the US. Dr Wolfgang Stein, one of the people researching the cray has said that in as little as three months, a single crayfish can multiply to 200 or 300!

<http://dgit.in/supercray>

Improvise. Adapt. Overcome

It's been found that animals are adapting to rapid climate change in their own way. Some species of animal that used to turn white during the winters are now staying brown year-round. At least twenty one species of birds and mammals change the colour of their coats during the transition from summer to winter to hide from predators.



However, with winters arriving later than usual and snow melting early, this change has

left them more vulnerable than protected as white tends to stand out on snowless terrain. As a result, animals are now adapting, and quite quickly at that. In a study, L. Scott Mills and his colleagues have mapped locations that could be potential hotspots to observe rapid evolutionary response to climate change.

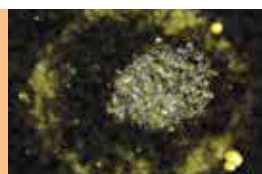
<http://dgit.in/blkorwht>



#10000YearClock

Jeff Bezos is building a giant mechanical clock that he says will work for 10,000 years. The clock is being built inside a mountain in West Texas and stands at a massive 500 feet tall. It'll derive its power from the Earth's thermal cycles. Why? To keep time for the next 10,000 years obviously.

<http://dgit.in/10000yrclock>



Bacteria that 'poops' gold

A rod-shaped bacterium called Cupriavidus metallidurans that lives in the soil is known for being able to survive large doses of toxic metals. It's also able to convert toxic versions of gold into inert solid gold nuggets. Start digging up your gardens!

<http://dgit.in/goldbact>



Man sues Microsoft for \$600m, or Win 7

A man has sued Microsoft for automatically upgrading his laptop from Windows 7 to Windows 10. He's seeking damages from Microsoft and CEO Satya Nadella for this violation of civil rights, in the form of either \$600m or a new copy of Windows 7.

<http://dgit.in/Win74ever>